

Newsletter Collaborating Platform for Epidemic Modelling and Data Analytics

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How can we ensure we are as well prepared as possible for a future pandemic?

At the closing event of ZonMw's Modelling for Pandemic Preparedness funding programme on June 16th, 2026, researchers presented the results of 20 innovative projects. From vaccination behaviour and patient distribution across regions to pharmaceutical supply chains and risk communication, these insights provide valuable guidance for future pandemic preparedness. But the real challenge starts now: translating scientific knowledge into policy and practice. Read the [event report](#) and explore [the magazine](#) featuring all 20 projects.



Connecting Survival Analysis and Infectious Disease Modeling

From Monday 15 to Friday 19 June 2026, the workshop “Connecting Survival Analysis and Infectious Disease Modeling” took place at the Lorentz Center in Leiden. The Lorentz Center is a workshop center that facilitates organization of workshops across scientific disciplines. This particular workshop was jointly organised by the Centre for Biostatistics at LUMC, the MOD department at RIVM, and Hasselt University in Belgium. There were 25 national and international participants from both infectious disease modelling and survival analysis background. Thanks to a sponsorship of the Collaborative Platform, the workshop finished with a symposium open to everyone interested in these topics, with Niel Hens, Daniela De Angelis, and Martin Wolkewitz as international speakers.

The topic centred around analysis of time-dependent problems, as in both survival analysis and infectious disease modelling, time is an essential component. The first three days of the workshop consisted of

group work and interactive discussions, to make analysis plans and start analysis of data from a simulated epidemic. Different groups worked on different questions, such as estimating serial intervals, vaccine effectiveness, and excess mortality. The simulated data and example code, vignettes, or other publications will be made public at a later stage. Based on this hand-on experience in collaboration between people from both disciplines, the last one and half day focused on lessons learnt and making a first draft of a review paper, that will be written in the forthcoming months.



RE-PASS workshop

A RE-PASS workshop featuring practical tabletop exercises for stakeholders on pandemic strategies in schools took place on 29 May 2026 in Utrecht.

During the workshop, participants were presented with three predefined scenarios describing an early outbreak of a novel pandemic respiratory pathogen. Working in groups, they made decisions on school-based interventions at multiple levels, including ventilation, screening, and school closures. Participants then explored how these interventions affected model-based epidemiological outcomes (infections among children and the wider community) as well as societal outcomes (school absenteeism).

In addition to demonstrating how the transmission model can support evidence-based policy advice during a pandemic, the workshop provided valuable insights into how stakeholders make and communicate decisions regarding school interventions. The RE-PASS team also gathered feedback and identified opportunities for further improving the model.



Inequalities in Infectious Disease Dynamics

From 22-24 April 2026, Federica Giardina (Radboud UMC) and Jantien Backer (RIVM) visited London for a symposium and workshop on Inequalities in Infectious Disease Dynamics. The event was organized by Rosalind Eggo and her team at the London School of Hygiene & Tropical Medicine.

The symposium on the first day consisted of presentations on a wide range of topics (see [programme](#)) and was well attended both in the conference room and online, showing the increasing interest in taking inequalities into account in transmission modelling. Jantien presented how participants of the PienterCorona study differed in contact behaviour by education level and how this changed over the course of the COVID-19 pandemic (published in [Eurosurveillance](#)).

Over the following two days, the workshop brought together around 30 participants. Federica presented a novel method to parameterize general contact matrices in a consistent way. Smaller groups dug into how socioeconomic status is defined and measured, how this differs between countries, and where the key data gaps and methodological challenges lie. A review/position paper drawing these discussions together is now in preparation, with a focus on policy relevance and needed methods development.



Upcoming Workshop on Societal Impact & Infectious Disease Modelling

27 October 2026, Utrecht

On Tuesday 27 October 2026, a workshop will be held in Utrecht on the topic: Bridging Societal Impact Calculations and Infectious Disease Modelling. This interactive session, will take place from 09:00 to 13:30 (including lunch).

This workshop will explore the existing and potential connections between models in the social sciences to explain social developments like changes in well-being or social cohesion, and those used by infectious disease modellers to describe the spread and control of infections. Together, we aim to generate ideas on how the social models of The Netherlands Institute for Social Research (Sociaal en Cultureel Planbureau, SCP) and infectious disease models can be jointly used to estimate the impact of crises and crisis policy.

Please note: There are only a limited number of spots available for this workshop. If you are interested and would like to secure a spot at the top of the list, please email collabforepidemodatanalytics@rivm.nl

Organising team: Evelien Eggink (SCP), Ka Yin Leung (SCP), Roelof Schellingerhout (SCP),



Join Us: Symposium “AI for Infectious Disease Modelling”

24 September 2026, Utrecht

We are excited to invite you to the upcoming symposium on AI for Infectious Disease Modelling, hosted by the Collaborative Platform for Epidemic Modelling and Data Analytics. The event will take place on September 24th, 2026 from 09:00–14:00 at Quinton House in Utrecht.

This symposium aims to bring together infectious disease modellers to explore the evolving role of artificial intelligence in our field. In addition to methodological discussions, we will examine how AI-driven models can be responsibly and effectively used to inform public health policy and decision-making.

Preliminary programme:

09:00 – 09:30: **Coffee & Registration**

09:30 – 09:45: **Opening & Welcome**

AI for Infectious Disease Modelling: Current Scope and Methodological Frontiers

09:45 – 10:30: **Joseph Tsui (University of Oxford)** on the wide use of AI in infectious disease modelling and the application of AI to disease forecasting and surveillance for outbreak preparedness

10:30 – 11:00: **Pieter Libin (Vrije University of**

Luc Coffeng (Erasmus MC), Don Klinkenberg (RIVM), and Valérie Eijrond (RIVM).

Brussels) on decision support for epidemic control with reinforcement learning and realistic simulators

11:00 – 11:15: Break

11:15 – 11:45: **Nan van Geloven (LUMC)** on causal inference for prediction and AI-based decision support

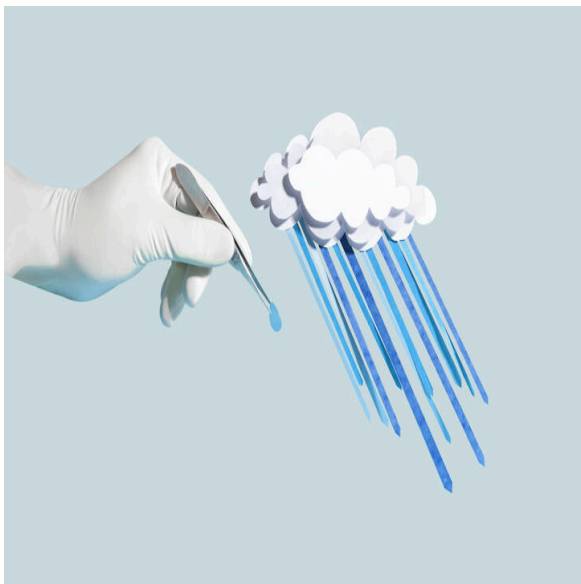
AI to Support Policy Advice

11:45 – 12:15: **Marino van Zelst (Ministry of Health, Welfare and Sport)** on policy needs and expectations from a government perspective

12:15 – 12:45: **Discussion / Q&A Panel**

12:45 – 13:45: **Lunch & Networking**

To secure your spot, please complete the [registration form](#) by **September 11th**.



Workshop “Spatial modelling and data integration for early warning at the start of the next pandemic”

We are pleased to announce the workshop: “Spatial modelling and data integration for early warning at the start of the next pandemic”

The workshop is part of the ZonMw program “Modelleren voor Pandemische Paraatheid: een oproep tot innovatie en kennisontwikkeling.”

The workshop represents a collaboration between two projects:

1. Intervention Modelling & Bayesian Inference of Transmission routes for early pandemic response (IMBIT)
2. Real-time spatial data-driven modelling of infectious disease outbreaks

When: September, 28th, 2026

Where: KNMI, Utrechtseweg 297, 3731 GA De Bilt.

Room: Buys Ballotzaal

Program

09:00 – 09:30 Registration and walk-in
09:30 – 09:45 Opening by Maarten van Aalst
(KNMI Director General)
09:45 – 10:30 “Using AI for impact-based
forecasting” (Jouke de Baar - KNMI)
10:30 – 10:45 Coffee break
10:45 – 11:45 “Data for epidemics – What data do
we need to prepare for the next pandemic?” TUE
and TiU research team
11:45 – 13:00 KNMI Field visit & lunch break (Two
groups alternate)
13:00 – 13:45 “IMBIT explained: project goals and
the multi-module IMBIT spatial model”
13:45 – 15:00 “DEMO of the IMBIT model under
different scenarios”. WUR, UTwente and RIVM
research team
15:00 – 15:30 Coffee break
15:30 – 16:00 “From research to operations (R2O)”
16:00 – 17:00 Panel discussion: Can simulation
models prevent the next pandemic?
17:00 – 17:15 Closing remarks
17:15 –

We have a limited capacity for 50 people. Please
register [here](#) before **September 14th**.

Best regards,
The organizing committee

*Ellen-Wien Augustijn (UTwente),
Elisa Benincà (RIVM),
Nelly Litvak (TUE),
Boris Schmidt (WUR),
Martijn Schoot Uiterkamp (TiU),
Gerard van der Schrier (KNMI),
Arno Swart (RIVM)*



Recent Publications

- Uiterkamp, M. H. S., van Dijk, W. J., Heesterbeek, H., van der Hofstad, R., Kiefte-de Jong, J. C., & Litvak, N. (2026). Value of risk-contact data from digital contact monitoring apps in infectious disease modeling. *Epidemics*, 100920. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.epidem.2026.100920>



Upcoming Events

- **September 24, 2026:** Symposium AI for Infectious Disease Modelling, *Utrecht*
- **September 28, 2026:** Workshop "Spatial modelling and data integration for early warning at the start of the next pandemic", *KNMI, De Bilt*
- **October 27, 2026:** Workshop on Societal Impact & Infectious Disease Modelling, *Utrecht*

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